

In the summer of 1946, Philip visited Elizabeth often. Her grandmother, Queen Mary, told a friend that the princess had made up her mind. The young couple hoped to marry, but the King wanted Elizabeth to see more of the world first.

In 1947, a royal visit to South Africa was planned. It was Elizabeth's first trip abroad, and the royal "firm" (as the King called the royal family) traveled together. In sunny South Africa, the family missed the 1947 winter, which

was one of the UK's coldest ever. Back in London, Philip sat in his overcoat

by candlelight, because of power cuts caused by fuel shortages.

Many others were doing the same. Three days before leaving for home, Elizabeth celebrated

her 21st birthday. Speaking by radio to the Commonwealth, she promised to dedicate her life to the duties that lay before her. "I declare before you all that my whole life, whether it be long or short, shall be devoted to your service ..."

